



Location

Stadtplatz 15,
4840 Vöcklabruck, AT

Building Type

former shopping centre

Reuse

multifunctional meeting,
commercial & social space

Usable Area

~ 1,300 m²

Governance Model

association + local actors +
public support

Opening

since October 2023



Initial Situation

- Vacancies & declining footfall in the town centre
- Structural challenges in the retail sector
- Need for new use concepts for town centres
- Desire for stronger collaboration among local stakeholders
- Low level of cooperation in the local sector

Objectives

- Revitalisation of the town centre
- Strengthening of the local economy & cooperation
- Creation of an inclusive meeting place
- Promotion of sustainable & regional offers

Key Actors

- **Main Operator:** KleinStadtbiotop association (*coordination & overall management*)
- **Partners:** local businesses, gastronomy & social organisationen (*use & co-creation*)
- **Support:** City of Vöcklabruck & funding programmes (e.g. LEADER)

Reuse Strategy

Strategy: multifunctional use under one roof - combining economic & social functions

Spatial programme:

- Retail (*market hall with multiple shops*)
- Gastronomy
- Social facilities
- Events & meeting spaces

Character: community-oriented, cooperative, inclusive

Operating Concept

- Organised through an association (*KleinStadtbiotop*)
- Cooperation between multiple businesses with shared structures
- Joint marketing & shared use of space

Key Features of the Project

- Solidarity-based economic model (*shared infrastructure & costs*)
- Combination of retail, social & cultural uses
- Strong focus on inclusion
- Consumption-free spaces as a core element
- Participatory development process with local stakeholders

Transferability

What makes this example particularly instructive?

- Shows new models for cooperative retail in small-town contexts
- Demonstrates how multifunctional use can revitalise vacant spaces
- Combines economic use with social functions

Who is this model suitable for?

- Small & medium-sized towns with vacancies in the centre
- Initiatives focusing on cooperation & regionality
- Projects aiming to combine economy, social functions & community